SACTCHECK · NCCP 00319

My complete treatment handbook

Carboplatin + Oral Etoposide

All information can be read on paper. Keep this with your treatment record.

> Use the urgent instructions and contact numbers in the following companion pages. Example telephone numbers must be replaced by your team before patient use. Your individual treatment plan takes precedence.

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SACTCheck v0.84.31 · Clinical, pharmacy and patient review pending. Formal consent is supplied separately.

Carboplatin + Oral Etoposide

This chemotherapy combination aims to control extensive-disease small-cell lung cancer, ease symptoms and help people live longer. Expected benefit depends on the cancer, general health and treatment choices. Ask what the team hopes it will achieve for you.

My overall treatment

Carboplatin is planned into a vein on Day 1, before oral etoposide. Etoposide capsules are prescribed twice daily on Days 1, 2 and 3 only, on an empty stomach. The cycle repeats every 21 days while treatment is helping and side effects remain acceptable. Your team decides when to delay, change or stop; the source does not set a fixed number of cycles.

Day 1	Days 2–3	Days 4–21 and review
Carboplatin infusion, then oral etoposide.	Oral etoposide twice daily.	No planned chemotherapy; support and tests continue. Another cycle needs team confirmation.

A typical 21-day cycle

Day 1	Day 2–3	Day 4–5	Day 6–20	Day 21
Infusion and first capsule day	Continue prescribed capsules	Capsules finish; support may continue	Recovery and monitoring	Review before another cycle

Timing may change after review. Side effects can occur on any day; there are no guaranteed safe days.

My tests and checks

When	What is checked	Timing / reason
Before treatment	**Blood count, kidney and liver tests** Required by regimen	Before the first course
During treatment	**Blood count** Required by regimen	Weekly before treatment, as arranged by your team
During treatment	**Kidney and liver tests** Required by regimen	Before each cycle; recent kidney result used for carboplatin dosing
During / after treatment	**Scans, review and any tumour markers** Team-agreed plan	Consultant-agreed dates; no fixed scan or tumour-marker schedule in this regimen

Between treatments

- Nausea and tiredness may occur; follow one reconciled sickness plan.
- Blood counts may fall after dosing ends. Fever or feeling unwell needs a call at any time.

Confirm capsule dose, twice-daily Days 1–3 and the Day 1 infusion appointment. Have the planned blood tests and report new symptoms before treatment. Keep the written support plan and contact numbers; do not double or extend capsule doses.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital’s temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE NUMBERS ONLY — your team must replace these before patient use.

What to watch for

You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

1 Ears / hearing

Carboplatin

Report tinnitus or hearing change promptly.

3 Chest / breathing

Both medicines

New breathlessness, chest pain or allergic swelling needs urgent assessment.

5 Stomach / bowel

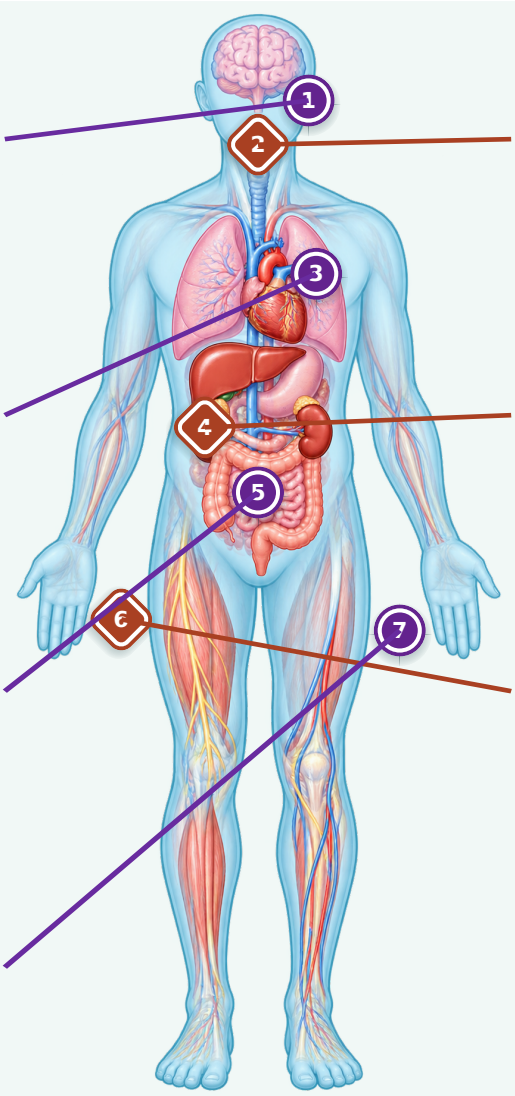
Both medicines

Use the prescribed sickness plan; call about persistent vomiting or diarrhoea.

7 Skin / blood counts

Both medicines

Report severe rash, fever, bruising or bleeding.



2 Mouth

Both medicines

Report ulcers or painful swallowing; poor intake can need urgent support.

4 Kidneys / fluids

Carboplatin

Report reduced urine or inability to drink; kidney tests guide dosing.

6 Hands / feet

Carboplatin

Report tingling, numbness, weakness or balance problems.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Call your unit urgently for fever at its stated threshold, shaking chills, sudden illness, new or worsening breathlessness, chest pain, unusual or uncontrolled bleeding, severe diarrhoea, repeated vomiting, inability to drink, very little urine, or a spreading/blistering rash. Swelling of the tongue/throat or trouble breathing can be an emergency. Report new tinnitus, hearing change, numbness or difficulty walking promptly.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE NUMBERS ONLY — your team must replace these before patient use.

Keep your treatment details to hand

Print this page **one-sided on A4 at Actual size / 100%**. Cut only the dashed outer border around both panels. **Do not cut the centre line.** Fold with FRONT and BACK facing out, then glue or tape the blank backs together. Finished size: **85.6 × 54 mm**. Keep the stamp side writable.

FRONT / CONTACTS

My Treatment Card

SACTCheck

Name: _____

Carboplatin + oral etoposide

Carboplatin Day 1; etoposide twice daily Days 1–3; every 21 days

Phase: _____ Cycle plan: team to confirm

Daytime (EXAMPLE) 087 12345678

Out of hours (EXAMPLE) 087 87654321

Unwell or fever? Call oncology now.
Severe breathing difficulty, chest pain or collapse: **112 / 999.**

EXAMPLE NUMBERS — replace before patient use.

BACK / TREATMENT RECORD

My cycle record

Rolling record — follow your agreed treatment plan.

Cycle	Date / initials

My treatment information

Latest treatment date: _____

Plan changed? Ask the team to update this card.

CUT outer border

FOLD centre — do not cut

Keep the record accurate

The team dates and initials each recorded treatment unit when complete. A cycle is complete after its final planned dose; a weekly-treatment stamp records that weekly dose. Delays, omitted doses or a changed plan need a note or a replacement card. A stamp does not approve the next treatment. Keep any medicine-specific alert card too.

Put your treatment page on your phone

Scan your QR and check the treatment name. Save that page to your home screen.

iPhone / Safari

Tap Share → Add to Home Screen. Select Open as Web App if offered, then Add.

Android / Chrome

Tap the three-dot menu → Add to Home screen or Install and create shortcut. Choose the shortcut option and confirm.

Menu wording varies. The QR opens information, not a personal record. Paper stamps do not update the website. Check that the saved icon opens the correct treatment.

Your local contacts and resources

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE NUMBERS ONLY — your team must replace these before patient use.

Hospital / team: _____ Backup contact route: _____

Additional local services and resources will be added when confirmed. Your team must check and complete this page before patient use.

SACTCheck v0.84.31 · NCCP 00319 v5 · 3 / 3
Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.

NCCP 00319 · VERSION 5

Your treatment, explained

Carboplatin + Oral Etoposide

21-day cycle

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

ACT ON SYMPTOMS, NOT THE CALENDAR

When to get help

Emergency: call 112 / 999

Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain: call emergency services. Do not wait for an online answer.

Contact your oncology service immediately

Temperature 37.5°C or higher, 36°C or lower, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell — even with a normal temperature. Call your unit urgently for fever at its stated threshold, shaking chills, sudden illness, new or worsening breathlessness, chest pain, unusual or uncontrolled bleeding, severe diarrhoea, repeated vomiting, inability to drink, very little urine, or a spreading/blistering rash. Swelling of the tongue/throat or trouble breathing can be an emergency. Report new tinnitus, hearing change, numbness or difficulty walking promptly.

Follow the urgent contact instructions from your treating hospital. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Outside clinic hours, use your instructed out-of-hours pathway or the emergency department.

This page does not diagnose symptoms or decide whether it is safe to stay at home. You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

Open your CUH contact / treatment card

Sources: hse · nccp · leaflet

Choose a topic to read

YOUR COMPLETE REFERENCE

Read what you need, when you need it.

Start with the overview, explore the cycle, or go straight to a question. Urgent advice is always available.

- How each drug works
- Day 1 infusion and Days 1–3 capsules in a 21-day cycle
- Your 21-day timeline
- Baseline and cycle-specific checks
- Whole treatment, scans and checks
- Tablets, visits and practical planning
- Why this treatment is being offered
- Preparing for the first cycle
- Taking chemotherapy at home
- What to watch for
- When to get urgent help
- Reviewing the course and next steps
- Supportive medicines
- Understanding the evidence

Questions to ask

Sources

UNDERSTAND YOUR TREATMENT

Your two chemotherapy medicines

This chemotherapy combination aims to control extensive-disease small-cell lung cancer, ease symptoms and help people live longer. Expected benefit depends on the cancer, general health and treatment choices. Ask what the team hopes it will achieve for you.

PLATINUM CHEMOTHERAPY

Carboplatin



Damages DNA through platinum links

Carboplatin forms links in DNA that interfere with copying and repair. This helps stop cancer cells dividing, but healthy tissues may also be affected. The dose is tailored using kidney function because the kidneys clear carboplatin.

Platinum reaches cells → DNA links form → Cell division disrupted

What to watch for

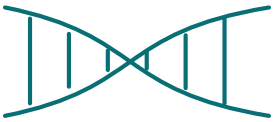
Report ringing in the ears, hearing changes, numbness or loss of function. Report infection or unusual bruising/bleeding promptly and describe any symptoms during the infusion.

Sources: nccp · carboplatin_smpc

TOPOISOMERASE-II INHIBITOR CHEMOTHERAPY

Oral etoposide

Capsules; supplied brand may vary



Interferes with DNA repair and cell division

Etoposide interferes with topoisomerase II, an enzyme involved in DNA structure and repair. DNA damage can stop cancer cells dividing. Healthy blood-forming and other cells can also be affected. Absorption by mouth varies, so oral and intravenous doses are not interchangeable.

Capsules absorbed → DNA repair disrupted → Cell growth slowed

What to watch for

Follow the exact capsule schedule and record doses. Report missed/vomited doses, infection, bruising, mouth ulcers or severe bowel symptoms. Do not double or convert doses yourself.

Sources: nccp · smpc · leaflet

The drawings are simplified explanations of drug action, not anatomical pictures or a prediction of response.

Explore your existing anatomy and side-effect map

THE BIGGER TREATMENT PLAN

Day 1 infusion and Days 1–3 capsules in a 21-day cycle

ONE INFUSION DAY PLUS THREE CAPSULE DAYS

Day 1 infusion and Days 1–3 oral chemotherapy



Carboplatin is planned into a vein on Day 1, before oral etoposide. Etoposide capsules are prescribed twice daily on Days 1, 2 and 3 only, on an empty stomach. The cycle repeats every 21 days while treatment is helping and side effects remain acceptable. Your team decides when to delay, change or stop; the source does not set a fixed number of cycles.

Carboplatin is planned into a vein on Day 1, before oral etoposide. Etoposide capsules are prescribed twice daily on Days 1, 2 and 3 only, on an empty stomach. The cycle repeats every 21 days while treatment is helping and side effects remain acceptable. Your team decides when to delay, change or stop; the source does not set a fixed number of cycles.

Sources: nccp

BASELINE → TREATMENT → FOLLOW-UP

Checks across treatment

These columns show order of care, not equal time intervals. Blood counts are arranged weekly before treatment; kidney/liver tests repeat before each cycle. Scans and extra tests follow the consultant plan. There is no fixed universal scan interval.

Check	Before starting	Day 1	Days 2–3	Recovery / next cycle	Course review
Treatment and oral doses	Confirm extensive SCLC and cisplatin unsuitability	Carboplatin infusion before oral etoposide	Oral etoposide twice daily on both days	No further etoposide until next authorised cycle	Continue only while benefit/tolerability support it
Blood counts	Baseline blood profile	Review pretreatment results	Extra review if illness or bleeding	FBC weekly prior to treatment, as arranged	Follow any persistent low counts
Kidneys, liver and albumin	Renal/liver profile; measured GFR preferred	Verify kidney-based carboplatin dose	Report poor intake or low urine	Renal/liver profile before each cycle	Reassess after illness or organ change

Check	Before starting	Day 1	Days 2–3	Recovery / next cycle	Course review
Hearing and nerves	Baseline symptoms; audiology if indicated	Report new changes	Report tinnitus, numbness or functional problems	Regular hearing/ neurological review	Follow symptoms that persist
Prevention, adherence and safety	Pharmacy capsule teaching; contact number	Dedicated carboplatin antiemetics; capsule sequence	Record capsules; follow reconciled antiemetics	Support plan covers two days after last SACT; report missed/ vomited doses	Review medicines and unused capsule return
Disease assessment	Confirm treatment aim	Clinical review	Report significant new symptoms	Tests/scans according to Consultant plan	Agree continuation, change or stop

The team arranges and reviews tests. This guide shows expected timing; it does not record completed appointments. NCCP 00319 v5 · official regimen

THE WHOLE TREATMENT JOURNEY

Carboplatin + Oral Etoposide: treatment and checks

Extensive-disease small-cell lung cancer · carboplatin + oral etoposide

Carboplatin is planned into a vein on Day 1, before oral etoposide. Etoposide capsules are prescribed twice daily on Days 1, 2 and 3 only, on an empty stomach. The cycle repeats every 21 days while treatment is helping and side effects remain acceptable. Your team decides when to delay, change or stop; the source does not set a fixed number of cycles.

Read from left to right. Columns show stages, not equal lengths of time. This is a general plan: no dates or personal information are needed. Your team confirms which steps apply and arranges appointments.

On a small screen, swipe the map sideways. The checks below give the same timing in words.

Treatment, tests and reviews across the course

Care / check	Before starting	Day 1	Days 2–3	Recovery / next cycle	Course review
Treatment and oral doses NCCP 00319	Confirm extensive SCLC and cisplatin unsuitability	Carboplatin infusion before oral etoposide	Oral etoposide twice daily on both days	No further etoposide until next authorised cycle	Continue only while benefit/tolerability support it
Blood counts NCCP 00319	Baseline blood profile	Review pretreatment results	Extra review if illness or bleeding	FBC weekly prior to treatment, as arranged	Follow any persistent low counts
Kidneys, liver and albumin NCCP 00319	Renal/liver profile; measured GFR preferred	Verify kidney-based carboplatin dose	Report poor intake or low urine	Renal/liver profile before each cycle	Reassess after illness or organ change
Hearing and nerves NCCP 00319	Baseline symptoms; audiology if indicated	Report new changes	Report tinnitus, numbness or functional problems	Regular hearing/ neurological review	Follow symptoms that persist

Care / check	Before starting	Day 1	Days 2–3	Recovery / next cycle	Course review
Prevention, adherence and safety NCCP 00319	Pharmacy capsule teaching; contact number	Dedicated carboplatin antiemetics; capsule sequence	Record capsules; follow reconciled antiemetics	Support plan covers two days after last SACT; report missed/ vomited doses	Review medicines and unused capsule return
Disease assessment NCCP 00319	Confirm treatment aim	Clinical review	Report significant new symptoms	Tests/scans according to Consultant plan	Agree continuation, change or stop

What each check is for

1

Before the first cycle

Before treatment authorisation

Confirm disease, organ function and safe home dosing.

Ask / act: Confirm consent, capsule teaching and prevention plan.

Sources: NCCP 00319

2

After Day 3

After the last prescribed capsule doses

Avoid unintended continuation or replacement.

Ask / act: Record doses and follow support plan; contact team about omissions/ vomiting.

Sources: NCCP 00319 · LEAFLET · ORALCARE

3

Before each new cycle

After recovery and review

Counts, organ function and tolerability may change.

Ask / act: Start another capsule course only after authorisation.

Sources: NCCP 00319

4

Course review

According to Consultant plan

Treatment should continue only while appropriate.

Ask / act: Discuss benefit, toxicity and next plan; return unused capsules.

Sources: NCCP 00319 · LEAFLET

At the next review, ask

- Which treatment phase am I in, and what happens next?
- Which test is expected next, who arranges it, and who explains the result?
- Who should I contact if an expected appointment has not arrived?

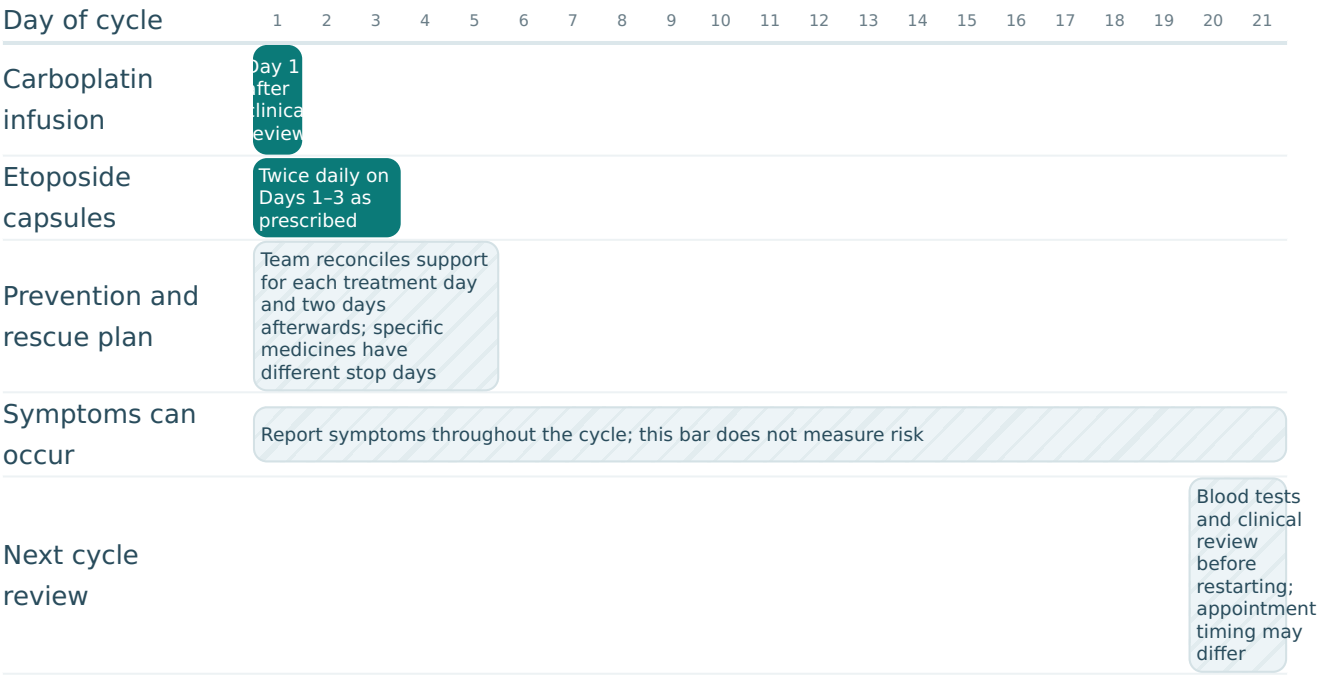
This map does not show whether a test has been ordered, booked or completed. Do not wait for a scheduled test if you develop new symptoms.

Sources checked 2026-11-02 · Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending · SACTCheck v0.84.29

Day 1 → Day 21: a general pattern

This is a visual orientation, not a prediction of your personal cycle. It shows when some effects often emerge and which effects are **not** tied to a particular day.

Carboplatin is planned into a vein on Day 1, before oral etoposide. Etoposide capsules are prescribed twice daily on Days 1, 2 and 3 only, on an empty stomach. The cycle repeats every 21 days while treatment is helping and side effects remain acceptable. Your team decides when to delay, change or stop; the source does not set a fixed number of cycles.



Before starting: Confirm tests, exact capsule directions, prevention medicines and urgent contact arrangements.

After Day 3: Etoposide capsules stop after the prescribed three days. Prevention medicines may continue according to the written plan.

Days 1–3: Day 1 includes carboplatin and the first oral doses; Days 2–3 use oral etoposide only. Do not substitute another etoposide schedule.

Across the course: Attend blood checks and review hearing, nerves and kidney function. The number of cycles depends on benefit and

tolerability; this timeline does not set a fixed course.

Why these bands stay broad: This shows one planned cycle. It does not predict when symptoms will occur or guarantee safe days. Use the prescribed calendar and team instructions if dates change. Band length does not show likelihood or severity, and the chart cannot tell you whether it is safe to receive treatment. NCCP 00319 v5 · official regimen ↗

There are no guaranteed “safe days”. Illness can be serious at any point in the cycle. Follow the unit’s temperature threshold and emergency instructions; call for shaking chills or sudden illness even without a high temperature.

Read the whole cycle as text

Day 1: Infusion and first capsule day

Carboplatin runs into a vein over about 30 minutes on Day 1. Etoposide is taken as capsules by mouth twice daily on Days 1–3, with the Day 1 sequence confirmed by the unit. The visit includes blood-result review, prevention medicines, preparation and observation. The pharmacy label gives your exact capsule strengths, number and times; do not calculate capsules from this guide. Confirm the capsule calendar, prevention plan and 24-hour number before leaving.

Day 2–3: Continue prescribed capsules

Follow the prescribed capsule count and twice-daily Days 1–3 schedule exactly, using the written calendar to record each dose. Take capsules on an empty stomach with water; ask the pharmacist to explain the timing around food. Do not chew, open or crush capsules. If swallowing is difficult, contact the team before taking them; do not substitute an intravenous preparation or change the dose yourself. Record each dose. Contact the team about a missed or vomited dose; do not take an extra dose yourself.

Day 4–5: Capsules finish; support may continue

Do not continue etoposide beyond the three prescribed days unless the treating team has changed the plan. Follow the written anti-sickness schedule; its medicines do not all stop together. Call if sickness prevents food, fluids or prescribed medicines staying down.

Day 6–20: Recovery and monitoring

Attend the blood tests requested by the team. Low counts, fatigue and mouth or bowel problems may develop between visits. Hearing and nerve symptoms can build across cycles. Use the emergency contact plan at any time; do not wait for the next infusion.

Day 21: Review before another cycle

The team checks blood counts, kidney/liver results, symptoms and treatment benefit before authorising another cycle. Do not start the next capsule course until your team confirms it. Bring the medicine list and dose record.

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Practical treatment planning

Agree the arrangements with your oncology team.



STEP 1

Before the visit

Confirm blood-test arrangements, transport, capsule prescription and the 24-hour contact number. Tell the team if you are unwell before travelling.



STEP 2

Time in the unit

Carboplatin runs into a vein over about 30 minutes on Day 1. Etoposide is taken as capsules by mouth twice daily on Days 1–3, with the Day 1 sequence confirmed by the unit. The visit includes blood-result review, prevention medicines, preparation and observation. The pharmacy label gives your exact capsule strengths, number and times; do not calculate capsules from this guide.



STEP 3

Access for the infusion

The team selects a cannula or appropriate existing central line for carboplatin. Etoposide is taken by mouth, so this regimen does not normally require a take-home infusion pump.



STEP 4

Taking capsules home

Follow the prescribed capsule count and twice-daily Days 1–3 schedule exactly, using the written calendar to record each dose. Take capsules on an empty stomach with water; ask the pharmacist to explain the timing around food. Do not chew, open or crush capsules. If swallowing is difficult, contact the team before taking them; do not substitute an intravenous preparation or change the dose yourself.



STEP 5

Home support

Keep capsules in their original pack, away from children and excess heat or damp, following the supplied label. The manufacturer leaflet advises gloves for handling and washing hands afterwards. Do not open a blister with a leaking capsule; ask the pharmacist what to do. Return unused capsules through the pharmacy; do not put them in household waste or drains.



STEP 6

Bring to review

Bring the capsule dose record, current medicines list and symptom notes. Ask for help if remembering doses or managing the pack is difficult.

Open practical treatment guide · Printable practical guide

Sources: NCCP 00319 v5 · official regimen. Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.

MAKE THE PLAN PRACTICAL

Support around the medicines

1 Your capsule prescription

Follow the prescribed capsule count and twice-daily Days 1–3 schedule exactly, using the written calendar to record each dose. Take capsules on an empty stomach with water; ask the pharmacist to explain the timing around food. Do not chew, open or crush capsules. If swallowing is difficult, contact the team before taking them; do not substitute an intravenous preparation or change the dose yourself.

2 Missed or vomited doses

If a dose is missed, do not double the next dose or extend the course. The manufacturer leaflet advises taking the next dose when due; inform your oncology pharmacist/team and follow your written plan. If you vomit after a dose, contact the team for instructions rather than automatically taking replacement capsules. BC Cancer specifically advises no repeat dose after vomiting within one hour unless the healthcare team directs it. Persistent vomiting or inability to keep fluids down needs urgent advice.

3 Safe handling and storage

Keep capsules in their original pack, away from children and excess heat or damp, following the supplied label. The manufacturer leaflet advises gloves for handling and washing hands afterwards. Do not open a blister with a leaking capsule; ask the pharmacist what to do. Return unused capsules through the pharmacy; do not put them in household waste or drains.

4 Sickness prevention across several days

Carboplatin Day 1 has high sickness risk; the oral etoposide-only days have a different risk. Your team provides one clear prevention and rescue plan covering treatment days and the next two days. Some medicines overlap; take only the reconciled prescription and do not repeat the full Day 1 plan on your own.

5 Fluids and symptom reporting

Ask for a drinking plan appropriate to your heart and kidney health. Report inability to drink or reduced urine promptly. Keep mouth-care advice and the emergency number nearby.

6 Other medicines and vaccines

Show the team all prescribed and non-prescribed medicines, supplements and vaccines. Etoposide has important interactions. Check before adding or stopping medicines; ask about contraception and fertility before treatment.

Sources: nccp · antiemetic · leaflet · oralcare

TREATMENT REFERENCE · 01

Why this treatment is being offered

Start with the individual aim and the exact prescription.

The treatment aim

This chemotherapy combination aims to control extensive-disease small-cell lung cancer, ease symptoms and help people live longer. Expected benefit depends on the cancer, general health and treatment choices. Ask what the team hopes it will achieve for you.

Sources: nccp

The precise regimen

This guide covers carboplatin plus oral etoposide for extensive-disease small-cell lung cancer in people unsuitable for cisplatin-based treatment. It does not cover an intravenous etoposide schedule or an added immunotherapy medicine. If the prescription differs, ask for its matching guide and consent discussion.

Sources: nccp

What the evidence can tell us

The studies cited by NCCP support platinum–etoposide treatment and provide background on using etoposide by mouth, but they did not test this exact carboplatin plus all-oral three-day schedule. The oral comparison used cisplatin and a mixture of intravenous and oral etoposide. A separate pooled analysis compared platinum choices across several trials. These results cannot give a precise survival estimate for this prescription or predict your individual benefit.

Sources: johnson · cocis

TREATMENT REFERENCE · 02

Preparing for the first cycle

Bring concerns about medicines, swallowing, memory or home support to the team.

Baseline checks

Blood, kidney and liver tests are needed before treatment. Kidney measurements help set carboplatin dosing; hearing tests may be arranged if needed. Tell the team about existing hearing or nerve problems.

Sources: nccp

Practice the capsule plan

Follow the prescribed capsule count and twice-daily Days 1–3 schedule exactly, using the written calendar to record each dose. Take capsules on an empty stomach with water; ask the pharmacist to explain the timing around food. Do not chew, open or crush capsules. If swallowing is difficult, contact the team before taking them; do not substitute an intravenous preparation or change the dose yourself.

Sources: nccp · leaflet · smpc · oralhandling

Fertility, pregnancy and breastfeeding

Discuss fertility preservation, contraception and any pregnancy plans before starting. Pregnancy and breastfeeding are excluded in this regimen. Your team explains the medicine-specific contraception period.

Sources: nccp · leaflet

TREATMENT REFERENCE · 03

Taking chemotherapy at home

An oral medicine still requires careful treatment checks.

Exact days and doses

Follow the prescribed capsule count and twice-daily Days 1–3 schedule exactly, using the written calendar to record each dose. Take capsules on an empty stomach with water; ask the pharmacist to explain the timing around food. Do not chew, open or crush capsules. If swallowing is difficult, contact the team before taking them; do not substitute an intravenous preparation or change the dose yourself.

Sources: nccp · leaflet · smpc · oralhandling

A missed or vomited dose

If a dose is missed, do not double the next dose or extend the course. The manufacturer leaflet advises taking the next dose when due; inform your oncology pharmacist/team and follow your written plan. If you vomit after a dose, contact the team for instructions rather than automatically taking replacement capsules. BC Cancer specifically advises no repeat dose after vomiting within one hour unless the healthcare team directs it. Persistent vomiting or inability to keep fluids down needs urgent advice.

Sources: leaflet · oralcare

Handling and storage

Keep capsules in their original pack, away from children and excess heat or damp, following the supplied label. The manufacturer leaflet advises gloves for handling and washing hands afterwards. Do not open a blister with a leaking capsule; ask the pharmacist what to do. Return unused capsules through the pharmacy; do not put them in household waste or drains.

Sources: leaflet

What to watch for

Tell the team early so symptoms can be assessed and treated.

Blood counts and infection

Both medicines can lower blood counts, increasing infection, bleeding or anaemia risk. Attend monitoring and report sudden illness, bruising or bleeding.

Sources: nccp · leaflet

Mouth, stomach and energy

Sickness, diarrhoea, constipation, mouth soreness, appetite loss, fatigue and hair loss may occur. Ask for help early; inability to drink or persistent vomiting needs urgent advice.

Sources: leaflet · hse

Hearing, nerves and kidneys

Tell the team about tinnitus, hearing change, numbness, weakness, balance problems or reduced urine. Some effects can persist after treatment.

Sources: nccp

Less common serious effects

Serious allergic or skin reactions can occur. Etoposide also carries a risk of secondary leukaemia; ask the team to explain serious and lasting risks in your situation.

Sources: leaflet · smpc

When to get urgent help

Use the unit’s 24-hour number and emergency instructions.

Urgent symptoms

Call your unit urgently for fever at its stated threshold, shaking chills, sudden illness, new or worsening breathlessness, chest pain, unusual or uncontrolled bleeding, severe diarrhoea, repeated vomiting, inability to drink, very little urine, or a spreading/blistering rash. Swelling of the tongue/throat or trouble breathing can be an emergency. Report new tinnitus, hearing change, numbness or difficulty walking promptly.

Sources: hse · leaflet · nccp

What to say when you call

Give the regimen name, last infusion and capsule dose, symptoms and when they began. Explain whether you can drink and pass urine. Do not delay calling to collect all the details.

Sources: hse

TREATMENT REFERENCE · 06

Reviewing the course and next steps

The number of cycles is a clinical decision.

Before another cycle

Attend weekly blood counts as arranged and kidney/liver tests before each cycle. The team reviews toxicity and benefit; do not restart capsules until authorised.

Sources: nccp

How long treatment continues

Carboplatin is planned into a vein on Day 1, before oral etoposide. Etoposide capsules are prescribed twice daily on Days 1, 2 and 3 only, on an empty stomach. The cycle repeats every 21 days while treatment is helping and side effects remain acceptable. Your team decides when to delay, change or stop; the source does not set a fixed number of cycles.

Sources: nccp

After a change or stop

Confirm which medicines stop or continue, how unused capsules are returned, and follow-up for ongoing symptoms. Ask who will contact you about the next treatment or supportive-care plan.

Sources: nccp · leaflet

Evidence and its limits

Ask which research best matches your treatment and goals.

The studies cited by NCCP support platinum–etoposide treatment and provide background on using etoposide by mouth, but they did not test this exact carboplatin plus all-oral three-day schedule. The oral comparison used cisplatin and a mixture of intravenous and oral etoposide. A separate pooled analysis compared platinum choices across several trials. These results cannot give a precise survival estimate for this prescription or predict your individual benefit.

Sources: johnson · cocis

PREPARE FOR THE CONVERSATION

Questions worth asking

Does having more side effects mean treatment is working?

No. Side effects do not reliably show whether the cancer is responding. Report them so they can be treated. Your team assesses benefit using the tests and review plan appropriate to your cancer.

Why might a dose be delayed or reduced?

Your team may allow recovery, investigate a symptom or reduce the chance of lasting harm. Ask which drug changes, why, and when review is planned. A delay does not itself mean treatment has failed.

What should I say when calling?

Give the regimen name, last treatment date, symptoms and when they started. Explain whether you can eat, drink, pass urine and manage usual activities. Give your temperature if available, but do not delay calling to collect details.

What belongs in the consent conversation?

The individual aim and likely benefit, uncertainty, reasonable alternatives including not proceeding, common and serious risks, lasting effects, fertility and practical concerns. You can ask for an interpreter, more time or another explanation and can reconsider your decision.

How many cycles should I use this passport for?

The passport provides reusable recording pages, not a prescribed course length. Your oncology team sets the duration and can provide extra pages.

Can I use this page to decide if blood results are safe?

No. Treatment decisions require the clinical protocol, symptoms, previous toxicity, organ function and the prescriber’s review. The patient page explains the checks and does not authorise treatment.

Are oral capsules a weaker form of chemotherapy?

No. Etoposide capsules are chemotherapy and can cause serious effects. Their absorption differs from an infusion, so only the treating team can choose or change the dose.

What if I miss or vomit a dose?

If a dose is missed, do not double the next dose or extend the course. The manufacturer leaflet advises taking the next dose when due; inform your oncology pharmacist/team and follow your written plan. If you vomit after a dose, contact the team for instructions rather than automatically taking replacement capsules. BC Cancer specifically advises no repeat dose after vomiting within one hour unless the healthcare team directs it. Persistent vomiting or inability to keep fluids down needs urgent advice.

Do I continue capsules every day until the next infusion?

No. This regimen prescribes twice-daily etoposide on Days 1–3 only. Use your own written calendar and wait for the team to confirm the next cycle.

Will I always have a fixed number of cycles?

The current NCCP source continues this regimen until disease progression or unacceptable toxicity, with ongoing review. Your team agrees the number of cycles and may stop or change earlier.

> **Try explaining the plan back:** Can you describe which medicine is given through a drip, which capsules you take twice daily on Days 1–3, what to do if a dose is missed or vomited, and whom to contact urgently?

SOURCE TRANSPARENCY

Where this information comes from

Regimen schedule: NCCP 00319 v5. Medicine explanations and safety information: sources below. The timeline is an educational illustration, not a measured risk curve or an individual prediction.

- NCCP 00319 v5 · official regimen
- Carboplatin manufacturer product information: mechanism and safety
- Etoposide capsules: manufacturer product information (Neon Healthcare)
- Etoposide capsules manufacturer patient leaflet, January2024
- BC Cancer: oral etoposide patient information (vomited-dose advice)
- Macmillan: etoposide capsules swallowing and handling advice
- HSE: chemotherapy side effects and urgent contact advice
- NCCP NCIS Medical Oncology antiemetics V8, Table1 and multi-day note
- Johnson1991 randomised cisplatin with IV versus mixed IV/oral etoposide
- Rossi2012 COCIS individual-patient meta-analysis: platinum choice in SCLC

SACTCheck · Developed by Dr Paul O’Brien · Sources checked 2026-11-02.
This information supports your treatment discussion. Your oncology team confirms your personal treatment and urgent-care plan.

Written source addresses

https://healthservice.hse.ie/documents/6920/319_V5_CarboplatinEtoposide_21days.pdf

https://www.medicines.org.uk/emc/files/pil.10534.pdf

https://www.bccancer.bc.ca/drug-database-site/Drug%20Index/Etoposide_oral_handout.pdf

https://www.medicines.org.uk/emc/product/3787/smpc

https://www.medicines.org.uk/emc/product/10534/smpc

https://www.macmillan.org.uk/cancer-information-and-support/treatments-and-drugs/etoposide

https://www2.hse.ie/conditions/chemotherapy/side-effects/

https://healthservice.hse.ie/documents/7180/Supportive_Care_Antiemetics_for_inclusion_NCIS_Medical_Oncology.pdf

https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/1845847/

https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/22473169/

BASELINE → TREATMENT → FOLLOW-UP

Checks across treatment

These columns show order of care, not equal time intervals. Blood counts are arranged weekly before treatment; kidney/liver tests repeat before each cycle. Scans and extra tests follow the consultant plan. There is no fixed universal scan interval.

Check	Before starting	Day 1	Days 2–3	Recovery / next cycle	Course review
Treatment and oral doses	Confirm extensive SCLC and cisplatin unsuitability	Carboplatin infusion before oral etoposide	Oral etoposide twice daily on both days	No further etoposide until next authorised cycle	Continue only while benefit/ tolerability support it
Blood counts	Baseline blood profile	Review pretreatment results	Extra review if illness or bleeding	FBC weekly prior to treatment, as arranged	Follow any persistent low counts
Kidneys, liver and albumin	Renal/liver profile; measured GFR preferred	Verify kidney-based carboplatin dose	Report poor intake or low urine	Renal/liver profile before each cycle	Reassess after illness or organ change
Hearing and nerves	Baseline symptoms; audiology if indicated	Report new changes	Report tinnitus, numbness or functional problems	Regular hearing/neurological review	Follow symptoms that persist
Prevention, adherence and safety	Pharmacy capsule teaching; contact number	Dedicated carboplatin antiemetics; capsule sequence	Record capsules; follow reconciled antiemetics	Support plan covers two days after last SACT; report missed/ vomited doses	Review medicines and unused capsule return
Disease assessment	Confirm treatment aim	Clinical review	Report significant new symptoms	Tests/scans according to Consultant plan	Agree continuation, change or stop

The team arranges and reviews tests. This guide shows expected timing; it does not record completed appointments. NCCP 00319 v5 · official regimen

THE WHOLE TREATMENT JOURNEY

Carboplatin + Oral Etoposide: treatment and checks

Extensive-disease small-cell lung cancer · carboplatin + oral etoposide

Carboplatin is planned into a vein on Day 1, before oral etoposide. Etoposide capsules are prescribed twice daily on Days 1, 2 and 3 only, on an empty stomach. The cycle repeats every 21 days while treatment is helping and side effects remain acceptable. Your team decides when to delay, change or stop; the source does not set a fixed number of cycles.

Read from left to right. Columns show stages, not equal lengths of time. This is a general plan: no dates or personal information are needed. Your team confirms which steps apply and arranges appointments.

Treatment, tests and reviews across the course

Care / check	Before starting	Day 1	Days 2–3	Recovery / next cycle	Course review
Treatment and oral doses NCCP 00319	Confirm extensive SCLC and cisplatin unsuitability	Carboplatin infusion before oral etoposide	Oral etoposide twice daily on both days	No further etoposide until next authorised cycle	Continue only while benefit/ tolerability support it
Blood counts NCCP 00319	Baseline blood profile	Review pretreatment results	Extra review if illness or bleeding	FBC weekly prior to treatment, as arranged	Follow any persistent low counts
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Disease assessment NCCP 00319	Confirm treatment aim	Clinical review	Report significant new symptoms	Tests/scans according to Consultant plan	Agree continuation, change or stop

What each check is for

1 Before the first cycle

Before treatment authorisation

Confirm disease, organ function and safe home dosing.

Ask / act: Confirm consent, capsule teaching and prevention plan.

Sources: NCCP 00319

2 After Day 3

After the last prescribed capsule doses

Avoid unintended continuation or replacement.

Ask / act: Record doses and follow support plan; contact team about omissions/vomiting.

Sources: NCCP 00319 · LEAFLET · ORALCARE

3 Before each new cycle

After recovery and review

Counts, organ function and tolerability may change.

Ask / act: Start another capsule course only after authorisation.

Sources: NCCP 00319

4 Course review

According to Consultant plan

Treatment should continue only while appropriate.

Ask / act: Discuss benefit, toxicity and next plan; return unused capsules.

Sources: NCCP 00319 · LEAFLET

At the next review, ask

- Which treatment phase am I in, and what happens next?
- Which test is expected next, who arranges it, and who explains the result?
- Who should I contact if an expected appointment has not arrived?

This map does not show whether a test has been ordered, booked or completed. Do not wait for a scheduled test if you develop new symptoms.

Sources checked 2026-11-02 · Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending · SACTCheck v0.84.29

Carboplatin + Oral Etoposide

Which treatment this guide covers This guide covers carboplatin plus oral etoposide for extensive-disease small-cell lung cancer in people unsuitable for cisplatin-based treatment. It does not cover an intravenous etoposide schedule or an added immunotherapy medicine. If the prescription differs, ask for its matching guide and consent discussion.

Supportive prescription draft for review. This is a regimen template. It is not an issued patient prescription; individual review and completion are required.

Separate scripts for each phase

Choose the active phase in the clinician workflow. Each script has its own medicines, timing and review checks.

- **Day 1 · carboplatin AUC5 plus oral etoposide** — high carboplatin + etoposide
- **Days 2–3 · oral etoposide, then two-day post-treatment support** — minimal to low etoposide

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00319/supportive-care.html

Carboplatin + Oral Etoposide

NCCP 00319 · Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Practical treatment planning

Agree the arrangements with your oncology team.

STEP 1

Before the visit

Confirm blood-test arrangements, transport, capsule prescription and the 24-hour contact number. Tell the team if you are unwell before travelling.

STEP 2

Time in the unit

Carboplatin runs into a vein over about 30 minutes on Day 1. Etoposide is taken as capsules by mouth twice daily on Days 1–3, with the Day 1 sequence confirmed by the unit. The visit includes blood-result review, prevention medicines, preparation and observation. The pharmacy label gives your exact capsule strengths, number and times; do not calculate capsules from this guide.

STEP 3

Access for the infusion

The team selects a cannula or appropriate existing central line for carboplatin. Etoposide is taken by mouth, so this regimen does not normally require a take-home infusion pump.

STEP 4

Taking capsules home

Follow the prescribed capsule count and twice-daily Days 1–3 schedule exactly, using the written calendar to record each dose. Take capsules on an empty stomach with water; ask the pharmacist to explain the timing around food. Do not chew, open or crush capsules. If swallowing is difficult, contact the team before taking them; do not substitute an intravenous preparation or change the dose yourself.

STEP 5

Home support

Keep capsules in their original pack, away from children and excess heat or damp, following the supplied label. The manufacturer leaflet advises gloves for handling and washing hands afterwards. Do not open a blister with a leaking capsule; ask the pharmacist what to do. Return unused capsules through the pharmacy; do not put them in household waste or drains.

STEP 6

Bring to review

Bring the capsule dose record, current medicines list and symptom notes. Ask for help if remembering doses or managing the pack is difficult.

Sources: NCCP 00319 v5 · official regimen. Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.

Carboplatin + Oral Etoposide

A record of what you experience

One cycle per page. Each medicine has its own symptom table. Mark the worst symptoms since your last review, when they occurred and what they stopped you doing. Overlapping symptoms can be recorded under more than one medicine; you do not have to identify the cause.

These are patient-language severity prompts, not a validated questionnaire or a formal CTCAE grading tool. Your team assigns the clinical grade. Serious symptoms override the columns: call without waiting to decide a severity level.

Carboplatin is planned into a vein on Day 1, before oral etoposide. Etoposide capsules are prescribed twice daily on Days 1, 2 and 3 only, on an empty stomach. The cycle repeats every 21 days while treatment is helping and side effects remain acceptable. Your team decides when to delay, change or stop; the source does not set a fixed number of cycles.

The four pages are reusable recording sheets, not a prescribed four-cycle course. Ask for additional sheets as needed.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital’s instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · DAYTIME

Insert numbers here

Acute Oncology Service

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · OUT OF HOURS

Insert numbers here

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Your own hospital / contact instructions:

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00319/

Full patient information, sources and visual timeline. No identifiers are encoded.

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

Carboplatin + Oral Etoposide

Cycle number: _____ Start date: _____ Next review: _____

The recording pages can be reused and do not prescribe a fixed number of cycles. Ask for extra pages as needed. Record both the Day 1 infusion and the Days 1–3 capsule doses; the team sets the course length. Record hair loss and other changes in the free-text notes.

Carboplatin · Platinum chemotherapy

Symptom	None	Mild	Moderate / call	Severe / urgent	Emergency signs
Nausea	☐ None	☐ Queasy but eating and drinking	☐ Intake reduced: contact the team	☐ Unable to maintain intake: urgent review	☐ Collapse / severe dehydration: 112/999
Hearing changes	☐ No change	☐ New ringing or muffled hearing: report promptly	☐ Conversation difficult: contact the team	☐ Sudden hearing loss: urgent assessment	☐ Sudden weakness or collapse: 112/999
Numbness / tingling	☐ None	☐ Mild change; usual tasks unaffected	☐ Limits buttons, writing or walking: call	☐ Washing, dressing or walking difficult: urgent review	☐ Sudden major weakness / paralysis: emergency help
Bleeding / bruising	☐ None	☐ New small bruise / brief bleed: report	☐ Repeated bleeding: call today	☐ Bleeding that will not stop: urgent help	☐ Heavy bleeding / collapse: 112/999

Oral etoposide · Topoisomerase-II inhibitor chemotherapy

Symptom	None	Mild	Moderate / call	Severe / urgent	Emergency signs
Nausea	☐ None	☐ Queasy but eating and drinking	☐ Intake reduced: contact the team	☐ Unable to maintain intake: urgent review	☐ Collapse / severe dehydration: 112/999
Mouth soreness / ulcers	☐ None	☐ Mild soreness; eating normally	☐ Painful; soft food needed: call	☐ Cannot eat / drink enough: urgent review	☐ Major breathing difficulty: 112/999
Diarrhoea	☐ Usual pattern	☐ Up to 3 extra stools above normal	☐ 4–6 extra stools/day or at night: call	☐ 7+ extra stools/day or dehydration: urgent review	☐ Collapse / severe dehydration: 112/999
Fatigue	☐ Usual energy	☐ Tiredness improves with rest	☐ Rest does not help; usual tasks affected: call	☐ Self-care difficult: urgent review	☐ Collapse: 112/999
Bleeding / bruising	☐ None	☐ New small bruise / brief bleed: report	☐ Repeated bleeding: call today	☐ Bleeding that will not stop: urgent help	☐ Heavy bleeding / collapse: 112/999

Dates / doses missed or changed / symptoms affecting daily life / questions:

Red flags override the table. Fever, shivers, suddenly unwell, chest symptoms or inability to drink: seek prompt advice. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse or severe chest pain: 112 / 999.

Carboplatin + Oral Etoposide

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NCCP 00319 V5 · ONE CYCLE, ONE PAGE

Carboplatin + Oral Etoposide

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Recording sheet 3 · Continue on another sheet if needed · SACTCheck v0.84.29

Carboplatin + Oral Etoposide

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Oral etoposide · Topoisomerase-II inhibitor chemotherapy

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Keep your treatment details to hand

Print this page **one-sided on A4 at Actual size / 100%**. Cut only the dashed outer border around both panels. **Do not cut the centre line.** Fold with FRONT and BACK facing out, then glue or tape the blank backs together. Finished size: **85.6 × 54 mm**. Keep the stamp side writable.

FRONT / CONTACTS

My Treatment Card

SACTCheck

Name: _____

Carboplatin + oral etoposide

Carboplatin Day 1; etoposide twice daily Days 1–3; every 21 days

Phase: _____ Cycle plan: team to confirm

Daytime (EXAMPLE) 087 12345678

Out of hours (EXAMPLE) 087 87654321

Unwell or fever? Call oncology now.
Severe breathing difficulty, chest pain or collapse: **112 / 999.**

EXAMPLE NUMBERS — replace before patient use.

CUT outer border

BACK / TREATMENT RECORD

My cycle record

Rolling record — follow your agreed treatment plan.

Cycle	Date / initials

My treatment information

Latest treatment date: _____

Plan changed? Ask the team to update this card.

FOLD centre — do not cut

Keep the record accurate

The team dates and initials each recorded treatment unit when complete. A cycle is complete after its final planned dose; a weekly-treatment stamp records that weekly dose. Delays, omitted doses or a changed plan need a note or a replacement card. A stamp does not approve the next treatment. Keep any medicine-specific alert card too.

Put your treatment page on your phone

Scan your QR and check the treatment name. Save that page to your home screen.

iPhone / Safari

Tap Share → Add to Home Screen. Select Open as Web App if offered, then Add.

Android / Chrome

Tap the three-dot menu → Add to Home screen or Install and create shortcut. Choose the shortcut option and confirm.

Menu wording varies. The QR opens information, not a personal record. Paper stamps do not update the website. Check that the saved icon opens the correct treatment.

Your local contacts and resources

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE NUMBERS ONLY — your team must replace these before patient use.

Hospital / team: _____ Backup contact route: _____

Additional local services and resources will be added when confirmed. Your team must check and complete this page before patient use.

SACTCheck v0.84.31 · NCCP 00319 v5 · Wallet-card sheet
Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.